

Meitu (1357.HK): New AI products/ features to drive ARR growth; 1H26 productivity/ leisure tools rev +40%/ 32% YoY; Buy

Meitu announced 1H26 Photo, video and design product revenues growth at 31% YoY to Rmb1.8bn, supported by productivity applications +40% YoY and leisure applications +32% YoY, while 9% lower than our previous estimates due to the exit of legacy business (stock photo). The company's MAU reached 282m by end of June 2026 (vs. 276m by end of 2025), and number of paying subscribers was up ~20% YoY to 18.4m, driven by productivity applications paying user growth at 30% YoY by Jun. 1H26 NI was guided at no less than 35% YoY on growth momentum and improving operational leverage. We remain positive on rising adoption of Meitu's tools with new AI features based on its MoE model, and contribution from new products (portrait-retouching AI agent, AI music video etc.). Maintain Buy.

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Exhibit 1: AI features and new products to drive Meitu paying subscribers



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

New product with strong ARR growth: The company's ARR (Annual Recurring Revenues) for AI-driven productivity tools remain high growth at 48% YoY to Rmb620m by June 2026 (vs. 56% YoY to Rmb580m by Mar 2026), driven by strong growth of Kaipai and Vmake. Management highlights the new product MVLand for AI music video generation doubled the ARR within 3 months after the new product launches, reflecting the user demand and capabilities of develop new products to bring incremental revenues. Besides subscription revenues, the rising user engagement for AI creation continues to drive revenues from AI credits by consumption to grow 46% QoQ in 2Q (vs. 46% in 1Q26).

Earnings revision: We factor in Meitu 1H26 guidance, and revise down earnings by 7%/ 5%/ 8% in 2026-28E mainly on lower revenue, due to company's exit of legacy

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business, while we remain positive on company's new AI features and new product expansion to drive paying ratio.

Exhibit 2: Earnings revision

Rmb m	2026E			2027E			2028E		
	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg
Revenues	5,096	4,842	-5%	6,811	6,524	-4%	8,984	8,492	-5%
GP	3,803	3,611	-5%	5,139	4,915	-4%	6,815	6,431	-6%
OP	1,308	1,202	-8%	2,043	1,926	-6%	2,980	2,728	-8%
Net income	1,293	1,205	-7%	1,905	1,801	-5%	2,752	2,528	-8%
EPS	0.28	0.26	-7%	0.42	0.39	-5%	0.60	0.55	-8%
Margins									
GM	74.6%	74.6%		75.4%	75.3%		75.9%	75.7%	
NM	25.4%	24.9%		28.0%	27.6%		30.6%	29.8%	

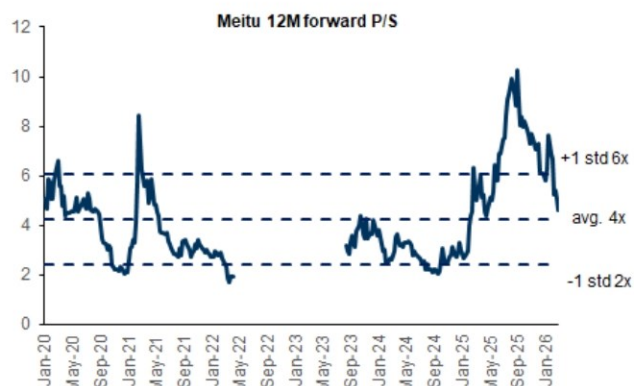
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation: Our target price is derived from a DCF-based methodology (unchanged) to capture long-term cash flow generation. We model stage 2 FCF growth in 2032E-2036E at 12% YoY, and terminal growth at 2%, which is consistent with our China Tech coverage. We discount the value at a WACC of 11.5% (beta at 1.3, risk free rate at 3.0%, market risk premium at 6.5%). With lower FCF estimates, Our DCF based target price is at HK\$12.3 (vs. previously at HK\$14.3).

Exhibit 3: Meitu DCF valuation

Rmb mn	Stage 1											Stage 2				
	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E	2032E	2033E	2034E	2035E	2036E
P&L																
Revenue	1,666	2,085	2,696	2,996	3,859	4,842	6,524	8,492	10,794	13,570	17,099					
YoY	40%	25%	29%	11%	29%	25%	35%	30%	27%	26%	26%					
Opex ratio	72.1%	60.5%	50.6%	59.6%	51.7%	49.7%	45.8%	43.6%	42.3%	40.7%	38.7%					
OP income	(76)	(74)	291	493	842	1,202	1,926	2,728	3,642	4,831	6,464					
YoY		NA	NA	NA	NA	43%	60%	42%	33%	33%	34%					
Pretax income	(11)	175	438	816	905	1,321	2,001	2,827	3,739	4,959	6,592					
Net income	(45)	94	378	799	698	1,205	1,801	2,528	3,331	4,404	6,036					
YoY		NA	NA	NA	NA	73%	49%	40%	32%	32%	37%					
GPM	67.5%	56.9%	61.4%	76.0%	73.6%	74.6%	75.3%	75.7%	76.0%	76.3%	76.5%					
OPM	-4.6%	-3.6%	10.8%	16.5%	21.8%	24.8%	29.5%	32.1%	33.7%	35.6%	37.8%					
NPM	-2.7%	4.5%	14.0%	26.7%	18.1%	24.9%	27.6%	29.8%	30.9%	32.5%	35.3%					
R&D spending (Rmb m)	545	586	635	911	945	1,218	1,583	2,041	2,600	3,274	3,420					
R&D%	32.7%	28.1%	23.6%	30.4%	24.5%	25.1%	24.3%	24.0%	24.1%	24.1%	20.0%					
Kaipai users (k units)			5	84	330	581	1,033	1,735	2,629	4,061	4,467					
Paying ratio			10.0%	12.0%	14.3%	15.5%	19.0%	22.0%	23.0%	24.5%	24.7%					
ARPU (Rmb)			40	143	188	217	236	268	315	360	380					
Meltuxiuxu users (k units)			3,921	5,387	7,148	8,038	10,357	12,247	14,192	16,243	17,055					
Paying ratio			3.1%	4.0%	5.3%	5.6%	7.0%	8.0%	9.0%	10.0%	10.5%					
ARPU (Rmb)			174	179	189	208	205	207	208	208	208					
Cash flow																
CCC	(414)	(244)	(194)	(306)	(213)	(189)	(180)	(170)	(150)	(100)	(98)					
Capex	(688)	(51)	(56)	(53)	(50)	(53)	(71)	(93)	(118)	(148)	(168)					
Capex to revenues	41%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%					
Free cash flow	(714)	183	357	693	1,207	1,252	1,720	2,474	3,012	3,648	4,925	5,496	6,133	6,845	7,639	8,525
YoY			95%	94%	74%	4%	37%	44%	22%	21%	35%	12%	12%	12%	12%	12%
Terminal growth																2%
Terminal value																92,014
Discount factor						1.00	0.78	0.69	0.61	0.54	0.48	0.42	0.37	0.33	0.29	0.26
Present value of FCF						1,252	1,342	1,705	1,835	1,962	2,340	2,307	2,275	2,243	2,211	2,180
Enterprise value 2026E (Rmb m)						45,177										
Cash and equivalents (net)						5,158										
Equity value in 2026E (Rmb m)						50,336										
Value per share (HKD)						12.3										
WACC assumption (2026E)																
Risk free rate	3.0%															
Beta	1.30															
Market risk premium	6.5%															
WACC	11.5%															

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Meitu 12M forward P/S

Source: Eikon Datastream

Price Target Risks and Methodology - 1357.HK

We derive our 12-month target price of HK\$12.3, which is derived from a two-stage DCF, where we incorporate a WACC of 11.5% and a terminal growth at 2% YoY. We are Buy rated on Meitu.

Key risks include 1) slower-than-expected AI adoption and monetization, 2) lower-than-expected paying ratios, and 3) fiercer-than-expected competition.

1357.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$12.30	Price: HK\$4.28	Upside: 187.4%
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Buy		GS Forecast				
Market cap: HK\$19.5bn / \$2.5bn Enterprise value: HK\$14.5bn / \$1.8bn 3m ADTV: HK\$483.4mn / \$61.7mn China Greater China Technology M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes			12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
		Revenue (Rmb mn) New	3,858.7	4,841.8	6,524.1	8,492.3
		Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	3,858.7	5,095.6	6,811.4	8,983.9
		EBITDA (Rmb mn)	895.1	1,255.4	1,973.3	2,772.7
		EPS (Rmb) New	0.15	0.27	0.40	0.56
		EPS (Rmb) Old	0.15	0.29	0.42	0.61
		P/E (X)	44.0	13.9	9.3	6.6
		P/B (X)	5.4	2.6	2.1	1.7
		Dividend yield (%)	0.7	2.1	3.1	4.4
		CROCI (%)	68.4	125.3	175.3	228.0
		12/25	6/26E	12/26E	6/27E	
EPS (Rmb)		0.07	0.12	0.15	0.18	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 30 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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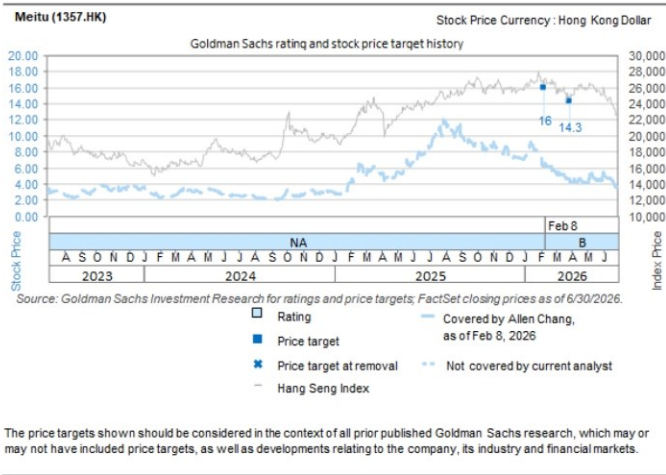
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)
Meitu (1357.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
31-Mar-26	14.30	4.29
08-Feb-26	16.00	6.24

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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